Answers and talk notes

Understand Statistical Questions

What your student is learning

Tonight we take the answers collected from a statistical question and draw them as a dot plot, then describe the shape the dots make.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** One answer from the data. Each dot stands for one answer from the data. So the answer is: One answer from the data.
2. **C.** 3. The value 2 appears 3 times, so 3 dots go above the number 2.
3. **B.** 5 is the most common answer. The tallest stack is the answer that happened most often, so 5 is the most common answer.
4. **A.** 9. Each dot is one student, so add the stacks: 2 + 4 + 3 = 9.
5. **D.** From 3 to 8, with every whole number labeled. The line must cover the least (3) to the greatest (8) value, with every whole number labeled: From 3 to 8, with every whole number labeled.

Talk about it

Which answer has the tallest stack, and what does that tell us about the group?

Home mission

A different situation: Ask each person at home how many glasses of water they drank today. Lay a paper strip numbered 0 to 5 on the table. Use a coin as a dot for each answer, stacked above its number. Which number has the tallest stack?

When they are stuck, ask

- What does one dot on this plot stand for?
- Which stack is tallest? What does that tell us?
- Do the two sides of the peak look about the same?

Try not to say

- One dot can stand for two or three students to save space.
- Skip the values that nobody chose, do not label them.
- Any plot with a tall middle is symmetric.